and maritime presence in the Indian Ocean Region on top of a growing footprint on land. Responding to China's naval ambitions, India is increasing its cooperation with littoral states in the IOR, including through agreements ensuring the Indian Navy access to military bases. India is investing in space sensors and naval capabilities to improve its Maritime Domain Awareness (MDA), and it deploys Boeing P-81 maritime patrol aircraft in the IOR. Like China, India is building aircraft carriers and plans to have a fleet of four SSBNs by 2022 to enable it to maintain continuous at-sea deterrent capability. Finally, India has made concerted efforts since the 1990s to acquire nuclear weapons and develop long-range ballistic missiles as a deterrent against China, which includes developing the K-4 submarine-launched ballistic missile. However, India's traditional nuclear strategy emphasising no first use and counter-value retaliation seems to remain in place towards China.[4]

Indeed, India's defence policy is responding to China's rise in various theatres, along the border in the Himalayas, as well as in the Indian Ocean Region, and India is building a nuclear triad. Many of these efforts certainly resemble elements of balancing, but, in their totality, these internal balancing measures currently fall short of hard balancing against China.

## *Economy*

China has emerged as India's largest trading partner. Their trade relationship is unbalanced and asymmetrical, unbalanced because India has a large trade deficit with China and asymmetrical in the sense that while China is India's largest trading partner, India only ranks as China's eighth-largest trading partner. India has facilitated Chinese investments, partly to increase India's manufacturing